# JORDAN AVERY

Robotics Researcher

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example.com

## EDUCATION

**Ph.D. Computer Science** — *Northfield University, Harbor City, WA* — 2019–25
- Advised by Morgan Castillo
- Thesis: Legible Robot Behavior in Shared Spaces

**M.S. Computer Science** — *Northfield University, Harbor City, WA* — 2019–21

**B.S. Computer Science** — *Redwood State University, Mesa Verde, CA* — 2015–19
- Honors College Scholar

## APPOINTMENTS

**Postdoctoral Research Associate** — *Lakeshore Institute of Technology* — 2025–

## INTERESTS

I develop and evaluate methods that let robots explain their behavior to the people who work alongside them. My work draws on machine learning, human-robot interaction and user research.

## PUBLICATIONS

### Thesis

[t1] "Legible Robot Behavior in Shared Spaces." J. Avery. *Northfield University*. Mar. 2025.

### Conference

[c4] "Asking Better Questions: Active Preference Learning for Ambiguous Tasks." R. Okafor, J. Avery, M. Castillo. *ICAS* 2026.

[c3] "Explaining Robot Failures to Remote Supervisors." J. Avery, L. Zhang, P. Ibarra, M. Castillo. *HRC* 2025.

[c2] "Shared Control for Teleoperation in Cluttered Environments." J. Avery*, S. Lindqvist*, T. Nakamura, M. Castillo. *Proc. Int. Conf. Intelligent Machines*. Oct. 2023.

[c1] "How People Interpret a Robot That Wanders Off Task." J. Avery, D. Mbeki, E. Halvorsen, M. Castillo. *HRC* 2021.

### Preprint

[a1] "A Few Words Are Enough: Language-Guided Policy Synthesis." H. Petrov, A. R. Desai, J. Avery, M. Castillo. *arXiv*:0000.00000, Jul. 2026.

### Journal

[j1] "Improving Language Understanding through Human-Robot Dialog." C. Marchetti, J. Avery, K. Osei, B. T. Ramos. *JMI* 2022.

### Patent

[p1] "Conversation analysis platform." F. Dubois, J. P. Avery. *US00000000*, Dec. 2023.

**Refereed Symposium, Workshop**

[w2] "Personalizing Shared Autonomy with Learned Priors." J. Avery, S. Lindqvist. *Workshop Assistive Autonomy, Int. Conf. Intelligent Machines*. Oct. 2023.

[w1] "Design Goals for Planning in General-Purpose Service Robots." J. Avery, G. Whitfield, C. Marchetti. *Symp. Planning for Everyday Robots*. Nov. 2020.

**Periodical Feature**

[f1] "What Delivery Robots Teach Us About Sidewalks." J. Avery, R. Okafor. *Example Magazine*, Jul. 2022.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

**Postdoctoral Research Associate** — *Lakeshore Institute of Technology* — 2025–

- Improving methods for learned policies to communicate their uncertainty [c4]

**Graduate Research Assistant** — *Northfield University* — 2019–25

- Developed and evaluated explanation methods for remotely supervised robots [c2, c3]
- Released an open-source toolkit for shared-control teleoperation

**Research Intern** — *Example Robotics* — 2022 Su.

- Prototyped a failure-recovery interface for warehouse manipulators

## GRANTS

**Documenting Public Art on the Northfield Campus** — 2025
Harbor City Arts Council, Special Projects Grant. $9,000. PI.

**A Speech Dataset of Household Robot Commands** — 2020
Service Robotics Foundation, Development Grant. $2,000. Co-PI.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**Teaching Assistant** — *Northfield CS 478 (Robotics)* — 2021 Sp.

- Updated assignments and built the autograder used in later offerings

**Teaching Assistant** — *Northfield CS 481 (Robotics Capstone)* — 2020 Wi.

- Supported six student teams building mobile manipulation projects

## MENTORING

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Priya Raman | Undergraduate Researcher » Ph.D. at Lakeshore | 2023–25 |
| Tomás Herrera | Masters Student » Example Robotics | 2022–23 |
| Mei Tanaka | Undergraduate Researcher | 2021–22 |
| Sam Okoye | Highschool Intern » Redwood State | 2021 |

## LEADERSHIP AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Organizer | Harbor City Robotics Meetup | 2022– |
| Organizer | Workshop on Assistive Autonomy, ICIM | 2023 |
| Peer Mentor | Graduate Student Mentoring Program, Northfield | 2020–22 |
| Reader | Ph.D. Admissions Committee, Northfield | 2020 |

**Reviewing**

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| HRC | ’26–’24 | JMI | ’25 | T-RL | ’22 |
| ICAS | ’26, ’23 | ICIM | ’24, ’21 | | |

## RECOGNITION

**Best Paper Award** — *Int. Conf. Human-Robot Collaboration* — 2025

**Graduate Research Fellowship** — *National Research Foundation* — 2020–25

**Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher Award Honorable Mention** — 2019
*Computing Research Society*

**Dean’s Honored Graduate** — *College of Engineering, Redwood State* — 2019

## SKILLS

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|---|---|
| Languages | Python, C++, JavaScript |
| Frameworks & Tools | PyTorch, ROS, Docker |
| Digital media | Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere |

## PERSONAL

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github.com/your-username
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